

# RED

## A 3-6 Adventure for Call of Cthulhu campaign By Wenye Zhou

### SCENARIO OVERVIEW

In the year 1920, the Investigators received a letter from **Dr. Carl**, a respected physician in the remote town of **Nestorac** (in rural Rhode Island), requesting them to investigate a mysterious disease spreading through the town. He offers to cover the costs of the investigation out of his own savings. With this, the Investigators arrive in Nestorac to find it surrounded by rugged valleys and mountains, nearly cut off from the outside world. An eerie atmosphere lingers over the tranquil town.

### SCENARIO STRUCTURE

The scenario is a sandbox. The investigators begin at **Carl's house** in the morning, and are given until midnight of the second day to explore the town to unveil its mystery. The major locations are **The streets, The Library, The Factory, The Mausoleum, The Clocktower**, as well as Rose's House and The Red Priest's House. Minor locations include the police station, the hotel the investigators stay at and the residence of minor NPCs.

The flow of the scenario is as follows: The players explore the four major locations, and gather to enter into the sewage system, where they answer the Runic gate's question and fight the Heart of corruption.

Keepers are encouraged to move information and NPCs around during play help players find lost information and lead them in the right direction. However, try to not give away the entire truth until players arrive at the Runic door, as doing so will undo much of the tension in the scene. Ideally let players figure out **The keeper's secret** after the red priest dies giving the incorrect answer.

## KEEPER'S SECRET

The Town, Nestorac, is the ancestor itself. The clock tower is the beating heart, the library the governing brain, the mausoleum the digesting stomach, the factory the fuming lungs.

The workers wear red since they are akin to red blood cells. The guards wear white since they are akin to white blood cells. The administrators in the library wear grey since they are akin to grey matter.

The outsiders in this town come into contact with the ancestor's blood from food and water from the underwater river of blood, or the mosquitos around town. They develop a fever and lose part of their soul: their name. They think about whether to stay in Nestorac forever, living and working. If they decide no, their name hunts and kills them, staying in Nestorac in their place. The names have no memories of the past, their memory starting from the moment of their creation. This is why Carl believes an amnesia disease is going around. There is no amnesia, only replacement.

The red priest tries to accelerate this process and wake the ancestor. From the recipe found in the book Alchemilus, she brews the convocation "catalyst of the work", drawing ritual circles at the library basement, the clocktower peak, and the mausoleum acid pool to gather the three primal liquids for the concoction. She tries to befriend the players and get to the Runic door at the end of the blood river, where she uses the catalyst to wake the Ancestor.

## START: CARL'S HOUSE

**Carl** is a doctor residing in the town of Nestorac. He's been at the town for a little over a year, and has recently noticed a strange disease going around town. He explains to the players that the symptoms involve mild coughing and fever, but more importantly **memory loss**. Many residents forget things and some even forget him. The cases have been increasing lately, and he admits he has never encountered similar diseases in his medical studies. He has hired the investigators to do an investigation of the town and **track down the source of this disease** to prevent it from spreading further.

Carl serves the players some **canned food** as snacks. If asked about it, he will explain he is a bit paranoid about the disease, and is unsure if the town food is safe to eat, and will only eat canned food imported from elsewhere.

Carl has arranged housing for the investigators at the **nearby inn**. He also provides players with 12 portions of bottled water and canned food, and warns them that eating or drinking within the town may carry risks, since it is currently unknown how the disease spreads.

Carl tells the player to find him if they need anything, and that they can return to his house for a group dinner to talk about the day's findings.

## **Day 1 Night : MIDPOINT CONVERSATION**

*Keeper's note: This conversation serves at the midpoint of the campaign. Treat it as a chance to gauge the player's deductions and encourage them to explore the entire town and lead them towards important evidence if they are stuck. Carl should be kind and compassionate to the investigators and have his own plans to leave Nestorac for the future. He should help any investigator in need and warn them of dangers. This is to setup the escalation when Carl is replaced with his name on the second day.*

Carl cooks for the players in the evening of day 1. Though using ingredients only from canned foods, he still tastes great. As night falls, he lights up a small fire in his yard and invites the investigators to have some roasted marshmallows around it while sharing what they have learned. Carl will ask about the source of the disease and how it spreads.

If the player answers "blood" or "A contaminated water source", he will mention the town's underground sewage system, and how its maintenance shaft is located somewhere in the factory.

If the player answers "The ancestor" or something occult, he will mention a cultist priest in red robes running around town recently. He also mentions that the library may have some occult text in store, as well as the town shop though it is rarely sold.

If the players answer anything else, he will attempt to agree with the players.

He also asks what the players want to do after they finish the investigation. Any infected player that gives an answer other than staying in Nestorac faces a sanity check. Failing the sanity check deals **1d4** sanity damage and forcefully say they want to stay in Nestorac.

If the investigators ask Carl about his plans, he says that he wants to travel around, helping what people he can and gather exotic recipes in the process. He shows the players some ancient latin books on making beef.

Before sleep, Carl says that he will be leaving tomorrow morning for some early patient appointments so the investigators should go ahead themselves. He also swats a mosquito on his arm, leaving a splatter of blood.

## **Day 2 : OTHER CARL**

By day 2, Carl is infected by the ancestor's blood from the mosquito and killed by his name. His body lies dissolved in the second floor of the mausoleum. "Carl" will wake the players and announce breakfast. The breakfast is made with fresh ingredients from the market.

If asked why he didn't leave early in the morning, "Carl" will say he misremembered the date. If asked why he cooks with fresh ingredients, "Carl" will say he always cooks like this". If asked about his future plans, he will say he plan to remain in Nestorac and be a doctor here forever. If asked about past events, he will either say he does not remember, or make something up.

Eating normal breakfast items like toast, fried egg, coffee, tea, and bacon infects the player.

The tomato juice on the table gives off the smell of fish, and drinking it infects the player, knocks out the player for 1d6 rounds, dealing 1d10 HP damage and 1d10 sanity damage

Passing a perception check on the jam reveals small nuggets of meat inside. Eating it infects the player, making them see a vision of the ancestor, trigger an extreme sanity check, dealing 2d20 sanity damage on failure.

"Carl" will not attack the players unless he believes his disguise is blown. If the players avoids eating the breakfast with convincing social skills or otherwise without triggering "Carl"'s suspicion, they can get by without a fight.

## **THE STREETS**

As the players walk out onto the street from Carl's house on day 1, they see the following sight:

*Much people walk on these streets, yet you seem to hear clearly every one. Their breath and their step. Wind blows across the street, conjuring up the*

*unswept dust into a reddish smog under the sun.*

Looking around, the players can see a tall **Clock Tower** standing in the middle of the Town. It chimes 9 times. Passing an Extreme Success on a **Listen** check allows the investigator to hear the sound of water flowing. On day 2, passing a normal Listen check will suffice.

People on the streets will ignore the investigators, and be hostile and uncooperative unless they are wearing red clothes or pass a Hard Success on a **Social Skill** check.

Talking with people on the street, the investigators find that the majority of people work in **the factory** West of this town. If asked about other prominent locations in the town, they will point to **the library** and city hall to the north, and **the mausoleum** to the south. Performing a **Spot Hidden** check reveals that a disproportionate amount of people on the street are wearing **red clothes**. During the conversation, no one will admit to having memory loss. Some will deny there is a disease going around, whilst others say it's a mild flu.

[Performing actions like endlessly harassing passers-by, stealing, or destruction of public property will result in the player encountering a town guard in **white uniform**. Failing to negotiate their way out will result in them being brought to the **police station**. Bribing or intimidating the guards will not work, as the investigators see the officers display very little greed or fear]

## **THE LIBRARY**

The Library is a two-floored cylindrical building, with wires and telegraph polls surrounding it.

### **EXPLORING THE SHELVES**

The first floor consists of haphazardly arranged shelves, coupled with a chaotic jumble of wires all across the floor and over shelves that stretch up to the ceiling and tunnel through the walls. The air smells of mold and dust, and the fluorescent lights hum incessantly.

If the investigators look around in the library, they will find **Grey**, the librarian sitting in a corner in red clothes.

*Grey is the brother of Ashcraft, a traveler that came to Nestorac and replaced by his name. He now acts as the librarian. Grey will say he's always been here if asked, and gives no indication of knowing Ashcraft.*

He tells the investigators that the first floor of this building is the town library, which is severely understaffed and rather messy.. He warns the players of potentially exposed electrical cables if they choose the venture inside to look for books during daytime. He also points the players to the second floor stairs, leading to the town hall in case the player has any questions.

Searching the library requires a Library use check, passing the check grants the information the player is looking for. The information players can obtain is listed below:

#### *Information on Town history*

Searching across the records allows the players to see that the town is isolated throughout its history, never being part of any major historical events. Passing a **History** check allows the players to find discrepancies between the different accounts of the town history, sharing little similarity.

#### *Information on The Ancestor*

**The Ancestor** is the ancestor of man, it is the first failed creation of Hemos, Bulwark of blood. On the day of its waking, the sun shall fade, and rivers of blood shall converge into a burgeoning sea, and reclaim all that is born of blood.

#### *Information on The Three Bulworks, Hemos, or Creation myths*

Creation Myth I : All that is comes from the three flowing streams. The icy **waters**, the rancid **blood**, and the ephemeral **ether**. From the mingling of streams came forms sublime and horrid: gods, monsters, shadows. The world drowns in interminable chaos. Civilizations rose and swiftly fell, for none can withstand the flooded sky, the rivers of blood, and the scorching stars.

#### Creation Myth II:

Outside of time rose **three bulworks**: Ethaerou, Bulwark of Sky, sealed the whispering gods above its eternal air. Ceruarkus, Bulwark of Sea,

sealed the horrid monstrosities below its roaring tide. Hemos, Bulwark of blood, sealed away the rancid blood and twisting shadows into vessels of flesh and blood.

If the player tries to search for any books unrelated to the above categories, they may find whatever relevant information they are looking for. If they succeed in a **Luck** check, they stumble into the book *Leviathan*.

After searching once through the library, the players encounter a mass tangle of wires around the central sections of the library. The air smells salty and moist around the section. If players try to pass through the exposed wires without protective equipment, they must pass a **Dexterity** check or take **1d4** damage. Passing through reveals a trap door leading down to the library basement.

The basement is small and cold. A bloody ritual circle is drawn in it, in the center a small droplet of icy water. Touching the water makes the investigator see a vision of gods and monstrous forms in a murky sea. Passing an **intelligence check** makes the player believe that all of humanity is linked to this sea from which gods arise, thus the reason for the similarity in ancient mythologies. (investigator take 1d4 sanity damage, +5 cthulu mythology)

Passing a perception check in the basement reveals another set of footprints, and a trail of droplets of this icy water on the ground, as though the bulk of it has been carried outside. This is from the red priest who came here to gather the primal water.

## **GOING UPSTAIRS**

The second floor is the town hall of the town of Nestorac. A set of workers wearing grey uniforms busily manage paperworks and work on large clunky computers. A man named Hobbson looks up from the desk and asks the players if they need any help.

*Hobbson is an adventurer investigating the supernatural events around Nestorac until he is replaced by his name, who now acts as governor. He will say he's always been here and knows nothing about being an investigator*

Talking to Hobbson about **names**, or mentioning the **past investigator Hobbson** will lead to him talking about names.

*Smith is one who smiths the metal. Baker is one who makes the bread. Names are no more than a mediate of conveying what the society expects of you, and your duty towards it. They exist beyond the individual person. They exist beyond us. Do you understand, investigator*

Talking to Hobbson about **The color of the clothes** will lead to him explaining their meaning:

*The red worker clothes symbolize the fraternity and connection between us.*

*The white guard uniforms symbolize the purity and sanctity of the guard's duty to protect this town*

*The grey outfits administration wears merely show our humbleness as ones who govern.*

He will deny being the past investigator Hobbson and will have no memories of it whatsoever. If players have attained information regarding the past Hobbson's appearance, passing a perception check will reveal Hobbson's appearance fits exactly with the description for the adventurer Hobbson.

Presenting Hobbson with concrete proof that he is the past investigator Hobbson will anger him and cause him to assault the players.

## **THE CLOCKTOWER**

Entering the clocktower, you find its interior surprisingly spacious. The myriad ticking of clocks echo through its dark staircase, spiraling upwards.

If the player proceeds to walk towards the stairs, they see a pocket watch, stopped at 9 am straight, plus a few extra seconds. The metal is warm to the touch. The investigators then hear a knocking at the door. A child is looking



for her missing father, who went to speak to the keeper of the clocktower yesterday, leaving home at 8:30 and going missing thereafter.

## **THE CLOCKTOWER'S CHIME**

The clocktower chimes at every hour from one to twelve times based on the hour. Every single chime does a base **1d4** sanity damage to all investigators inside the tower who fail a sanity check. The difficulty of the sanity check increases with every sanity check the player passes, increasing from requiring a normal success, to hard, to extreme.

Investigators that take sanity damage from the chime will have certain thoughts emerge in their heads.

### **Taking sanity a first time:**

*The difference between flesh and steel is superficial. A difference in form, not function.*

### **Taking sanity damage a second time:**

*What has a face, two hands, and keeps the time?*

### **Taking sanity damage subsequently:**

*A vision of hanged men, swaying in the clocktower like pendulums.*

*Time is tangible. Time is physical. The organs of time sit, contorting, contracting. Around it, unending red.*

Players get a turn to act between every turn. Allow the players to do a little more action each turn if they are in a terrible situation. Players that reach indefinite insanity from the chime turns into a pocket watch stopped at the exact time of their insanity or death.

## **SCALING THE CLOCKTOWER**

Due to the chimes from the clocktower, players have a maximum of 1 hour before scaling and exiting the clocktower.

Upon going up the clock tower, players hear clanking footsteps ahead of them. Going closer reveals a mechanical husk blocking the way, having tools in hand and performing maintenance on the clocktower wall, seemingly ignorant of the player. The husk will assault the player if they try to ascend

further or attack the husk. The husk moves precisely every second, and has incredible strength. The husk is easy to avoid due to its regular movement. Inspecting the gap in the wall will reveal masses of shifting flesh, gear, and tendon, dealing 2d4 sanity damage to the player unless they get a hard success in the sanity check

Proceeding further up the clocktower, the investigators reach a section of stairs about 5 meters in length, clearly worn and prone to collapse. Passing a **Jump** or **Climb** check will allow players to rush past, collapsing the stair section in the process. Usage of ropes, climbing the clocktower wall horizontally, or repairing the stairs are all valid solutions as well. Players that fall from the stairs get a **dexterity** check to perform a cliffhanger. If they fail, player that fall takes **2d10 damage**.

As players ascend the clocktower, their perception of time warps. They see the staircase littered with pocket watches. Infront, another husk stands, but it now moves erratically due to their warped perception of time, and becomes difficult to avoid or combat.

Investigating the pocket watch shows all the minute hands point at 12.

Succeeding a perception check shows a note next to a pocket watch on the floor:

Contraptions made to measure time, instead grinds to a stop because of it  
Only the most primal means for time keeping comes close to eternity.

If the players focus on their heartbeat, they regain their perception of time, and may trivially avoid the husk. Else enter battle with the husk with disadvantage.

At the peak of the clocktower lies a locked wooden door. The lock is easily picked and the door is frail enough to be forced open. Inside is the room where the mad keeper of the clocktower resides. The walls of the room are draped in pocket watches and a great dome resides at the top of the room, with carvings showing the celestial bodies in motion. A bloody ritual circle is drawn in the center of the room, right underneath the dome, and contains some grains of ethereal sand on the floor, shifting between solid, liquid, and gas. The keeper is a frail old man Agnes in his 70s, so skinny you can see every bone extruding from his body. He is mad and cannot communicate normally, only mumbling strange phrases under his breath.

Though he seems threatening, he will not attack the players. Succeeding in a psychoanalysis check can allow the players to communicate to him in a limited fashion.

Agnes is a watchmaker that came to Nestorac for a living. He is replaced by his name, who becomes the keeper of the watchtower

Touching the grains of sand makes the investigator see a vision of the stars, moving like clockwork across the sky, grinding the greatest civilizations into shapeless sand. Of all the eldritch horrors man have faced, none is more terrifying than the malicious timekeepers that appear each night. (investigator take 1d4 sanity damage, +5 cthulhu mythology)

## **THE MAUSOLEUM**

The towering metallic house stands, an obelisk in the noxious fumes from the industrial waste around. The acidic air waters your eyes and itches your skin.

A guard stands in front of the mausoleum, and prevents the player from entering, saying that the mausoleum is not open to visitors. If the investigator is wearing red and passes a social check to convince the guard they are indeed from Nestorac, the guard will ask who they are visiting. Providing a name actually in the mausoleum will grant entry. A mausoleum worker escorts them inside.

The entrance hall of the mausoleum is twisting and confusing. Sometimes, the investigator sees the walls moving and shifting about. The mausoleum workers lead the way, showing the investigators towards a massive acid pool. Around it, workers wearing protective equipment are lowering bodies into the pool, creating constant hissing sounds in the air. Investigators that peer into the pool or stand close to it take 1d4 sanity damage. Next to the pool, a group of workers is scrubbing off a bloody ritual circle, inside lies small grains of salt.

Touching the salt makes the investigator see a vision: Humanity comes from salt from the sea, and returns to salt. Salt is transferred, restructured, but never destroyed. Salt is the pursuit, the beginning and the end. (Investigator take 1d4 sanity damage, +5 cthulhu mythology)

## **TOMB OF THE NAMED**

The second floor of the mausoleum is locked. Inscribed on the wall are the words: "Those whose names outlive them". It has more ornate decorations, and consists of individual coffins, each filled with acid. The names of the dead are covered in a thick layer of dust, but can still be seen on the coffins. The coffin for Hobbson and Grey can be found, as well as the majority of the NPCs the investigators met. On day 2, it will have Carl in one of the coffins. Looking at the half dissolved Carl deals 3d4 sanity damage to the player unless they succeed in a hard sanity check.

## **THE FACTORY**

As you approach the factory, you see its towering chimneys reach up to the sky, covering the sun with its smoldering exhaust.

Approaching the factory, there is a man in a red uniform sitting in the shade. He explains to the investigators that only workers are allowed into factory grounds.

If they wish to work and have proper qualifications, they may start immediately. Investigators who have higher than 60 dexterity, or knowledge of electrical or mechanical repairs, are allowed to maintain the fans. Players who has higher than 60 Strength are allowed to work in the assembly line. The person can also be tricked or convinced using a hard social check.

After the players are admitted into the factory, they are each given a red colored shirt as the factory uniform.

## **FACTORY INTERIOR**

Entering into the factory, you see sunlight spill into the factory through the spinning fan blades. The air smells of metal and coal, leaving your eyes red and itchy. The mechanical contraptions around moves precisely, its deafening drones filling the factory walls.

The first floor of the factory is mostly covered in assembly lines, where workers assemble products and components. The raw materials are piled on carts taken from the factory storage. There are ladders that lead onto a second floor walkway, where giant metal fan blades spin to ventilate the factory. At the end of the walkway is a locked door labeled control room.

Inside are all the keys to the factory doors and a map of the factory. A guard and administrator Franz stand in the room. Franz oversees the operations of the factory and has a gun. Franz will stay in the admin room and make his guard checkout any anomalous activity outside. Any other person is forbidden from entering the control room.

Messing with the assembly line or tampering with the fan will cause the workers to turn aggressive towards the player. The commotion outside will attract the guard. If the fans are jammed or turned off, the factory quickly fills with a noxious fume that does 1d4 damage each turn to everyone inside.

Looking at the map, investigators see a small locked room labeled "Sewage maintenance shaft". Workers are forbidden to wander the factory. If investigators sneak around the factory, they can find the locked "Sewage maintenance shaft" by themselves.

Opening the door to the maintenance shaft reveals a long claustrophobia stairway descending into the darkness. After descending for about 10 minutes, the investigators find themselves in a room with an altar of some sorts, with three giant stone slabs sitting on the altar. Three urns sit at the feet of the altar.

Passing a **listen** check will allow investigators to hear the sound of rushing water outside. Passing a **perception** check reveals a recess in the wall, possibly a hidden passage to be activated.

Pouring water/sea water, air/sand, and blood/salt into the three urns makes a loud noise, and the recess in the wall opens up, revealing a path to the Sewage system. Players can also use explosives here if they manage to obtain any either by starting with them or negotiating some from ashcraft.

## **RESIDENT AREA**

The players can find an abandoned house in the resident area with a strange sulfur smell inside.

## **TOWN SHOP**

The town shop sells goods produced by the factory as well as goods shipped from outside of Nestorac. Players can buy utility items like ropes, torches, medical equipment, canned food from outside Nestorac, as well as basic weapons.

Each afternoon, the employee Ashcraft has her shift at the store, where she sells contraband items like adrenaline and guns, as well as curios and ancient texts.

Ashcraft's inventory for sale contains the below items, as well as any other reasonable contraband. Ashcraft also barter for rare trinket, book, or materials that the players find or bring.

|                                          |                            |                                                                                              |
|------------------------------------------|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Adreneline                               | Requires credit rating >40 | +20 to combat rolls for 5 turns.                                                             |
| Panacea                                  | Requires credit rating >70 | Heal 1d10 HP and 1d10 Sanity                                                                 |
| Explosive                                | Barter only                | Deals 2d6 explosive damage in 5m area. Can be used to blow up doors                          |
| Creation myth occult scroll (III and IV) | Requires credit rating >50 | See below                                                                                    |
| Hobbson's monocle                        | Requires credit rating >35 | The monocle has Hobbson's name inscribed on it<br><br>+5 to perception checks                |
| Agnes's pocketwatch                      | Requires credit rating >45 | The pocketwatch has Agnes's name inscribed on it<br><br>Immune to chimes from the clocktower |

*Creation myth III*

If asked her purpose in the town, she will say she came here about 3 weeks ago to look for her missing brother. Her brother Grey is a traveling artist of sorts, and his last letter was 2 years ago from the town of Nestorac, before he disappeared completely.

## **DINER**

The diner sits beside a pond and sells various fish dishes to passers by. Inspecting the pond, investigators will see its water having a faint red tint, and notice the fish inside the pond grow unusually large. The diner closes at 6pm. If investigators approach after 6 pm, they can run into giant mosquitoes that assault them.

If the investigators about past investigators here or the disease, some townspeople who are eating will remember an adventurer named Hobbson several years ago, also investigating the disease, but disappeared mysteriously.

They can also encounter **Rose** there, who is secretly the red preist, who tries to join up with the players and get to the Ancestor's heart to wake it.

## **THE SEWERS**

Walking forth into the opening, you see the river of blood, roaring, spreading its stench across the cavernous tunnel. Above, hundreds of titanic metallic pipes reach into the bloody river from the ceiling, twisting and winding like tentacles.

The investigators find two maintenance boats that can carry them down the stream.

After about 30 minutes, the investigators reach a small island with a giant runic door towering over the investigators.

## **RUNIC GATE**

*Keeper's note: This is the ideal place for players to figure out the truth about the Ancestor. Rose's answer to the runic door serves to show players a wrong answer to the Runic gate and its consequence.*

*One possible hint system is to have each player roll intelligence check, and granting those that success a recount of their journey through either the clocktower, the masoleum, the factory, the library, or the streets.*

## **THE HEART**

The great door opens. Inside, a gargantuan heart inside a great pool of blood. With the sound of turning gears, curved white pillars rise from both sides of the room, converging onto a titanic spine on the tall ceiling. The primal beat begins, the sound of every human heart beating as one.

Enter combat with **The Ancestor's Heart** (See Monster Appendix)

## **EPILOGUE**

The hideous beat stalls, then stops. The pulsating mass grows rigid, as blood drains from the room. Above, figures in the street dissolve into dust, swept into the sun's crimson light. Others look around horrified, like waking from a lost dream. The spinning turbines of the factory creep to a halt, the noxious smoke from the mausoleum dissipates, and the clock tower stands silent, never to sound again.

## **MONSTER APPENDIX**

**CLOCKWORK FLESH , Monster in clocktower**

**STR 110 CON 60 SIZ 60 DEX 30 INT 30**

**APP — POW— EDU — SAN — HP 25 DB: +1D4 Build: 0**

**Move: 5 MP: 0**



**DESCRIPTION:** An automaton, outwardly encased in metallic plates, but moving sinue and bones can still be seen through the cracks in the plates. A construct made by the clocktower for its protection. Mindlessly protects the clocktower, moving by the second. Extremely strong and sturdy.

**BEHAVIOR:** Clockwork Flesh will move and attack if players get within 3 meters from it without stealth. It moves according to the second. Once this pattern is identified, investigators gain bonus while evading its attacks.

Town Guard

**STR 70 CON 70 SIZ 70 DEX 70 INT 50**  
**APP 50 POW 50 EDU 50 SAN 100 HP 25 DB: 0 Build: 0**  
**Move: 0 MP: 0**

Extremely capable fighters enforcing the order of the city. Accessing them, players should see that they are more powerful than they initially appear. Combat with one only happens when players have messed up and act as a punishment mechanic.

**Behavior:** Angered by causing extreme unrest or doing severe criminal activity like murder, or resisting arrest. Will use baton to fight players. If they feel outnumbered, will send a pulse through the electric grid calling for reinforcements. Using this causes triple the guards to show up in 10 rounds, up to 30. Players can see this being used as all wires nearby will flash blinding white.

**Mosquito**

**STR 50 CON 50 SIZ 100 DEX 30 INT 20**  
**APP 20 POW 20 EDU 0 SAN - HP 20 DB: 0 Build: 0**  
**Move: 0 MP: 0**

Encountered near the swamps of the restaurant. Huge and swelling from the corruption of the blood, they are larger than a human and has a great maw to tear its enemies. Being damaged results in infection by the ancestor's blood.

**Behavior:** Will relentlessly attack the players if encountered. Can only be encountered after players go near the restaurant's pond region after 6pm

### **Heart, Eldritch heart of the ancestor**

*Keeper's note: This is the final, climactic encounter. The main difficulty of the campaign comes from the puzzle runic door. This fight is more cinematic in nature. The investigators SHOULD NOT get party wiped in this fight. However, it is good to knock several investigators to death's door for tension and acceptable to have one or two investigators die depending on the roll.*  
Feel free to manipulate the Heart's HP to achieve the sweet spot of knocking investigators to death door without party wiping them.

**STR — CON — SIZ 200 DEX — INT 70**

**APP — POW— EDU — SAN — HP 130 DB: 0 Build: 0**

**Move: 0 MP: 0**

**DESCRIPTION:** The beating heart of the Ancestor. The heart towers all the way up to the ceiling in the pool of blood.

### **Behavior:**

The heart will take three actions per turn: An **opening action**, an **early action** with Dex 70 and a **late action** with Dex 40

For its **opening action** , the Heart will always use **Visionary**

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vision of silence    | You see a vision...<br>The flowing blood and pulsating organs churn in harmonious silence.<br><b>Investigators are silenced this round</b>                                                       |
| Vision of compassion | You see a vision...<br>A looming titan of mingled blood, composed of a thousand names. The end of loneliness and strife.<br><br><b>When an investigator takes damage, all investigator takes</b> |

|                        | damage                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Vision of substitution | <p>You see a vision...<br/>In rapid metabolism, thousands die and are replaced. Formally the same, functionally identical.</p> <p><b>Two random investigator's stats are interchanged.</b><br/><b>The two investigators take 1d6 sanity damage</b></p> |
| Vision of the work     | <p>You see a vision...<br/>The great work</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

For it's early action, If there is not already a summon in battle, it will summon either **Hand of the Many**, **Eyes of Judgement**, or **The Calling Maw**. If all three has already been summoned, it will summon **Shapeless bulk**.  
If there is already a summon, it will use **Sustenance** to heal the summon for **1d6 HP**

For its late action, it will use either **Mold the flesh** or **Mold the mind** to the investigator that it perceives to have the highest threat, dealing 1d6 HP and sanity damage respectively.

The heart's beat slows once it drops below half HP, removing its early action.

### Hand of the Many

**STR 70 CON — SIZ 120 DEX — INT 70**

**APP — POW— EDU — SAN — HP 20 DB: 0 Build: 0**

**Move: 4 MP: 0**

**Description:** A monstrous hand with more little hands stretching out from within it's palm

**Behavior:** Will use either **Hand of mercy** or **Iron Fist** on the nearest investigator.

|                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Hand of mercy</b> | <p>The hand and little hands reach out to the investigator, offering them salvation.</p> <p>If the investigator fails the sanity check, they will start involuntarily walking towards the Heart each turn at their move speed until they succeed the sanity check. If they reach the heart, they will plunge into the heart, killing them instantly.</p> |
| <b>Iron Fist</b>     | The hand slams at the investigator, dealing 1d4 damage and dealing 3m knockback                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## Eyes of Judgement

**STR 70 CON — SIZ 120 DEX — INT 70**

**APP — POW— EDU — SAN — HP 20 DB: 0 Build: 0**

**Move: 4 MP: 0**

**Description:** A giant cluster of bush-like eyes, Growing taller and taller from the pool of blood, wriggling and swaying

### **Behavior:**

If grown, cast **eye of judgement**

Will **grow** if not damaged this turn, else cast **unblinking gaze**

|                         |                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Grow</b>             | The eyes now tower over the battlefield, reaching up to the ceilings. Eyes become <b>grown</b>                                                            |
| <b>Eye of judgement</b> | Induce extreme feelings of guilt to the target investigator. Failing the sanity check will make them attack themselves until they succeed in sanity check |
| <b>Unblinking gaze</b>  | Burning the eye socket of the target                                                                                                                      |

|  |                                                                                                                 |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | investigator and forcing them to gaze at the eyes. Deal 1d4 burn damage until investigator breaks line of sight |
|--|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

## Calling Maw

**STR 70 CON — SIZ 120 DEX — INT 70**

**APP — POW— EDU — SAN — HP 20 DB: 0 Build: 0**

**Move: 4 MP: 0**

**Description:** A giant fleshy mouth, waiting for something to eat

### Behavior:

If fed, always use **Devour**

Else, use **Inhale**, then **The Calling**

|                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Devour</b>      | The mouth devours what you throw it, spraying acidic saliva to the investigator nearest to it while eating, dealing 1d4 damage. The mouth will take damage if fed anything sharp, burning, poisonous, or explosive. |
| <b>Inhale</b>      | Enables <b>The Calling</b>                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>The Calling</b> | All investigators are grabbed by the ankles by red hands from the bool of blood. All investigators take <b>1d6</b> sanity damage each turn until they break free with a Strength check                              |

## Shapeless bulk

**STR 70 CON — SIZ 120 DEX — INT —**

**APP — POW— EDU — SAN — HP 30 DB: 0 Build: 0**

**Move: 4 MP: 0**

**Description:** A crude mass of shapeless meat, incapable of anything except slamming those near to it.

**Behavior:** Will **tackle** anything near 4 meters from it for 1d4 damage. If no target is found, it will use the turn to move.

## **SPECIAL CAMPAIGN RULES**

When investigators reach OHP or lose enough sanity to enter indefinite insanity, instead enter **death's door**. Roll a d6 to determine the fate of the player. Start at X = 5, decrease X by 1 each time the player hits **death's door**. X cannot go below 2.

|     |                                                                                                                                                |
|-----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | Investigator rises above their adversity. The light of humanity shines brightest in the dark. Gain <b>Virtue</b><br>[See <b>virtue table</b> ] |
| 2-X | The oppressive situation cracks the investigator, making them develop an <b>affliction</b><br>[See <b>affliction table</b> ]                   |
| X-6 | All roads lead to Rome. The Investigator meets finally meets their fatal end.<br><b>[Investigator dies or goes permanently mad]</b>            |

### **Virtue table - d6**

|         |                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Fated | <i>The universe has greater plans for you, far beyond this wretched hole.</i><br><br><b>Recover 1d6 HP and 1d6 sanity</b><br><br><b>Your next roll will be a critical success</b> |
|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 2 Luminous    | <p><i>The stars shine brightest in the void of night</i></p> <p><b>Recover 1d6 HP</b></p> <p><b>Recover 1d10 sanity for investigators in your party</b></p> <p><b>Emit light 10 meters around you for 10 turns</b></p>                  |
| 3 Furious     | <p>The raging mind leaves no space for fear, nor pain.</p> <p><b>Recover 1d6 HP</b></p> <p><b>Recover 1 sanity. You cannot lose sanity for 10 turns</b></p>                                                                             |
| 4 Focused     | <p><i>There is method in this madness, Eyes inside this storm.</i></p> <p><b>Recover 1d4 HP</b></p> <p><b>Recover 1d4 sanity</b></p> <p><b>For 5 turns, enemies have penalty against you in combat</b></p>                              |
| 5 Enlightened | <p><i>Between life and death, you catch a glimpse of the coveted beyond</i></p> <p><b>Recover 1 HP</b></p> <p><b>Recover 1 sanity</b></p> <p><b>For 2 turns you are immune to magic attacks</b></p> <p><b>+15 Cthulhu mythology</b></p> |
| 6 Hope        | <p><i>You are the hope. The turning point.</i></p> <p><b>Heal to full HP and Sanity</b></p> <p><b>For the next 3 turns, get advantage on every action and take an extra</b></p>                                                         |

|  |                                        |
|--|----------------------------------------|
|  | <b>action at the end of every turn</b> |
|--|----------------------------------------|

### Affliction table d10

|                  |                                                                                                       |                                                                                            |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Hopeless       | <i>No hope in this abyss.<br/>No stars in the pictured<br/>darkness</i>                               | Can no longer regain<br>sanity                                                             |
| 2 Denial         | <i>This cannot happen! It<br/>can not. It is not.</i>                                                 | Sees a different reality<br>than the current one,<br>and acts accordingly                  |
| 3 Paranoid       | <i>Handshakes in dark<br/>places! You see through<br/>their insidious smiles.</i>                     | Becomes paranoid and<br>acts accordingly.<br><br>Will no longer accept<br>help from allies |
| 4 Irrational     | <i>Frail tools of rationality<br/>must be discarded in<br/>the face of this<br/>maddening reality</i> | Each turn in combat,<br>have 50% chance to act<br>randomly                                 |
| 5 Fading         | <i>Your race is run. The<br/>candle flickers and<br/>show the unavoidable.</i>                        | At the end of each day,<br>take 1d4 damage. After<br>each time, take 1d4<br>more.          |
| 6 Nyctophobia    | <i>The darkness hides<br/>more than the<br/>unknown.</i>                                              | Fear of dark<br><br>Sanity check fail: 1d4<br>per round                                    |
| 7 Necrophobia    | <i>Each decaying body<br/>wears your face</i>                                                         | Fear of corpse<br><br>Sanity check fail: 1d4<br>per round                                  |
| 8 Entomophobia   | <i>The legs twitch, the<br/>wings buzz, responding<br/>to your every move</i>                         | Fear of insects<br><br>Sanity check fail: 1d4<br>per round                                 |
| 9 Anthropophobia | <i>Strange looks in their<br/>eyes. What creatures</i>                                                | Fear of people                                                                             |



|               |                                   |                                                       |
|---------------|-----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
|               | <i>are they?</i>                  | Sanity check fail: 1d4 per round                      |
| 10 Hemophobia | <i>You've seen too much of it</i> | Fear of blood<br><br>Sanity check fail: 1d4 per round |

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